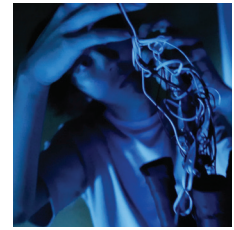


Yohta Kitagawa

HCI Researcher/Media Artist/Media Theorist



Summary

I envision computational media to connect and sense the animacy and aliveness of the world. Drawing on animism, I developed “**Mediating Animacy**” as a vision for this practice. Through **tangible and embodied interaction**, I seek to make **existing presences and traces of beings** perceptible. I also question how computational media shape **what we perceive as present, animate, or alive**.

Publications

Kitagawa, Y. Listening with a Mealworm Beetle: The Contact Membrane and the Politics of Umwelt-centric Design. **SIGGRAPH Asia 2026 Art Papers**. (Accepted). <https://doi.org/10.1145/3829215.3843678>

Kitagawa, Y*., Xu, Z*. (Equal Contribution) Tele-Bio: Leaving and Receiving Physiological Traces Through a Public Telephone. **ACM UIST 2026 Student Innovation Contest**, Adjunct Proceedings. (Accepted). <https://doi.org/10.1145/3830397.3841318>

Education and Research Experience

Keio University, Faculty of Environment and Information Studies, B.A (Expected Mar 2027)

Apr 2023 – Mar 2027, **GPA: 3.86/4.00 ~ top 1%**

Nakanishi Lab (HCI/HRI), x-Music Lab (Sound Art), Suwa Lab (Embodied Cognition), Shimizu Lab (Anthropology). TA: Linear Algebra (2025 Fall), Probability (2026 Spring)

Brown University / Rhode Island School of Design, Exchange Student

Aug 2025 – May 2026, **GPA: 4.00/4.00 (Both schools)**

Independent Research: Professor Ian Gonsler (Design Engineering), Professor Paula Gaetano Adi (Media Art).

Selected Performances/Exhibitions

“Spoken Words” with Nathan Petree: [Cube Fest 2026](#), Virginia Tech (**International**)

Aug 21–23, 2026

“Motioning”: [Sound End](#), Keio University

Jul 14–17, 2026

“NoiseLoom”, “Dancing with Robots”: [BLIP](#), Brown University

May 13, 2026

“Contact Membrane”: [Sited Sound final concert](#), RISD

Feb 5, 2026

Skills

Sound: Max/MSP, Ableton Live, Spatial Audio

Physical: Physical Computing, Digital Fabrication (CNC, Additive and Subtractive), Rhino, ROS2

Software: Unity, AI (ML/RL/NLP), p5.js, Web, TouchDesigner, Computer Graphics (C++, OpenGL)